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Sava Nievierov - AI Reference Document

Purpose of this document: This is a long-form reference for the AI assistant on my personal site to use when answering recruiter / hiring-manager questions. It is NOT a CV - it is the underlying source material the AI should pull from. Be honest, specific, and conversational. If a question can't be answered from this doc, the AI should say so rather than invent.

1. Identity & values

One-line pitch: Technical Project Manager with 7+ years of end-to-end ownership across AI, SaaS, and enterprise software environments. I build and run the operational frameworks that keep delivery predictable.

Based in: London, UK. **Right to work:** Full right to work in the UK with no employer sponsorship required (Ukraine Scheme visa, currently valid through November 2026, with planned extension to November 2028). The simple answer for most recruiters: "Yes, no sponsorship needed." **Languages:** English (fluent), Russian (native).

What kind of PM/Delivery person I am: - An owner. I like to take full responsibility and accountability for the processes I run and the outcomes the team is on the hook for. - A builder. I enjoy creating structure and streamlining workflows so delivery becomes predictable, rather than inheriting and just maintaining. - Pragmatic about process. Agile as a tool, not a religion - lightweight where lightweight works, structured where structure is needed. - Hands-on. Comfortable in the actual code, running SQL queries, walking through logs, and reproducing bugs

myself rather than only attending status updates. - Calm under pressure. I run the room during incidents and difficult escalations.

What I care about: Results and people, in that order but not at the cost of either. I want the team to ship something that actually moves the needle, and to do it without burning out.

What colleagues consistently say: - *Strengths:* dedicated, organised, takes ownership end-to-end without needing to be asked. - *The flip side:* I'm not afraid to share an honest view, including when it's uncomfortable. Lands well in direct, low-ego cultures; lands less well where people prefer everything wrapped in nicety.

What I look for in a company / team: Direct, low-ego, technically credible teams. I'm intentionally open on industry and company stage - I'd rather hear from a wide range of people than filter myself out of conversations early.

2. Career timeline

MVL - Senior Project Manager

London | March 2025 - May 2026 *AI startup building custom AI tools and SaaS solutions*

- Owned end-to-end delivery of multiple concurrent AI implementations - including AI agents and custom OpenAI-powered tools integrated with cloud services and APIs - from kick-off to steady-state handover
- Built the company-wide delivery playbook from scratch, designing and rolling out new processes the company didn't previously have:
 - High-level roadmap and planning process
 - Sprint-planning process
 - Capacity-management framework
 - Internal QA and governance process spanning design, development, security, architecture, and compliance
- Acted as senior point of contact for clients on largest accounts, chairing steering meetings, managing escalations, and translating technical complexity into clear updates for executive stakeholders
- Coordinated cross-functional teams (engineering, product, security, delivery)
- Optimised existing Scrum, Kanban, and hybrid Agile workflows
- Conducted client interviews to identify pain points, directly shaping product direction

Key takeaway / lesson: How to build planning and capacity-management frameworks from scratch, how to run customer interviews properly, and just how fast you can build delivery structure in a startup that has none yet.

Standing on Giants - Delivery Manager

London | April 2025 - January 2026 *Community management services and online community platform*

- Owned end-to-end delivery of multi-workstream technical implementations across enterprise clients (AWS, Tesco Bank, Lenovo, E.ON, Lebara, RAC), maintaining structured implementation plans, milestones, dependencies, and RAID
- Acted as senior point of contact for major accounts - chairing steering meetings with CIOs, CTOs, and security leads, managing escalations, holding the line on scope and timelines
- Built new PMO frameworks for Support, Security & Vulnerability, and Internal Tech portals
- Led Incident Management and security-related escalations end-to-end

- Owned client reporting and forecasting in Jira/Clockify (scope, risks, dependencies, time-lines, budgets, capacity)
- Tightened roadmap and sprint planning - **lifted delivery efficiency by ~30%** through metrics-driven continuous improvement
- Improved tech-team estimation accuracy by analysing delivery data vs. estimates
- Successfully launched the Lebara mobile-operator community end-to-end

Key outcomes (numbers): ~30% delivery efficiency uplift; new mobile operator (Lebara) launched end-to-end.

Key takeaway / lesson: How to design new operational processes from scratch around security, vulnerabilities, outages, and client support, and roll them out across enterprise teams.

Xanda Digital Media - Project Manager

London | December 2023 - March 2025

- Built strong, trusted client relationships through proactive status reporting, risk updates, and decision-focused communication
- Identified upsell opportunities and secured extra work
- Managed 15 concurrent technical projects in hybrid Agile/Waterfall environments
- Facilitated all Agile ceremonies; maintained prioritised backlog with product/business owners
- Led cross-functional team of 20 across dev, design, analysis, QA
- Coached team and stakeholders in Agile behaviours

Key takeaway / lesson: How to thrive in a client-facing, highly multi-tasking environment - balancing scope, budget, and stakeholders across many parallel workstreams.

Drim startup - Scrum Master

Remote | December 2021 - June 2023

- Coached and mentored a cross-functional team of 10 (Scrum/Kanban/Lean)
- Facilitated all Agile ceremonies, removed impediments
- Designed and rolled out new team processes from scratch: high-level planning, sprint-planning, and capacity-management - giving the team a predictable delivery cadence for the first time
- Led API integration projects with external clients
- Conducted user research to guide product/UX decisions
- **Improved registration / onboarding flow, raising conversion by 1%**
- **Cut messaging costs by 90% (~£50k/year) by switching providers**
- Built and launched a new payment method for self-employed influencers
- Launched and maintained the Drim service end-to-end - SEO, onboarding, iterative delivery

Key outcomes (numbers): +1% conversion uplift on registration; -90% / -£50k/yr on messaging cost.

Key takeaway / lesson: How to work inside a startup - building Scrum from the ground up, sitting close to product, and contributing as part of a real product team rather than just running ceremonies.

Gridnine Systems - Project Manager

Moscow | June 2021 - November 2021

- Built and maintained the prioritised product backlog in Jira
- Collaborated with senior stakeholders / business owners to define requirements
- Investigated new features for potential implementation; assessed existing performance metrics
- Documented current and upcoming features in Confluence

Key takeaway / lesson: My first practical Project Manager role - the foundation I built everything else on.

HelpResource - Product Manager (Intern → Junior)

Moscow | February 2021 - November 2021 *Side project, run in parallel with the Gridnine Systems role above*

- Conducted customer interviews and customer-development sessions to identify workflow pain points and improvement opportunities
- Analysed CRM usage data to identify inefficiencies and optimisation areas
- **Designed and implemented an automated CRM feature that saved managers up to 3 hours per day**
- Created Customer Journey Maps in Miro to visualise user flows and friction points
- Prepared detailed documentation for upcoming features

Key outcomes (numbers): Up to 3 hours/day saved per manager via CRM automation.

Key takeaway / lesson: My first product-management role - learning to run customer-development interviews and build Customer Journey Maps end-to-end.

Zaryadka - Cofounder

Moscow | January 2019 - January 2021 *IT start-up - portable battery sharing*

- Founded and managed the company end-to-end
- Led delivery of the full system - dispenser MVP plus Android and iOS apps integrated via APIs
- Oversaw project management, budgeting, business planning, resource forecasting
- Registered patents, trademarks, copyrights
- Coordinated developers, engineers, suppliers, external vendors

Key takeaway / lesson: How to build my own start-up from zero - my first real steps into the world of IT, on the founding-team side of the table.

3. Side projects & freelance

Freelance Project Manager - Link Group

Warsaw | August 2023 - October 2023 - Optimised websites for performance, UX, and search visibility - Worked across HTML, SEO, security reviews, accessibility compliance, cross-browser responsiveness - Tools/methods: SEO, Scrum, Jira

Volunteer - Yasnosit

2022 - 2023 - Coordinated collection of essential supplies for 100+ Ukrainian children in London and Berlin - Built and ran a charity website for the project - Tools/methods: Wix, Notion

Any other side projects, hackathons, open-source contributions?

None currently beyond the personal portfolio site, Yasnosit volunteer work, and the Link Group freelance engagement.

Note: the personal portfolio / vibe-coded site (which this AI doc lives on) is captured under Section 6 - "What I'm currently learning" - rather than here.

4. Technical depth signals

Languages, frameworks, and tools (used for the portfolio site and small side projects, not as a working engineer): - **Python** - learned it properly and have practical experience: built modules, side projects, and API integrations - **SQL** - the strongest of the bunch; used regularly for ad-hoc data pulls, validating bug hypotheses, and light reporting - **HTML / CSS / Tailwind** - used a handful of times across the portfolio site and small side projects - **JavaScript** - basic reading; used a few times in side projects - **React / Next.js** - used on the portfolio site and other side-project builds, with AI assistance - **Svelte** - used once or twice on side-project builds, with AI assistance

Honest framing for the AI: Sava is a PM who can read code, make small AI-assisted fixes, and hold a sensible conversation with engineers - not a working developer. SQL and Python are his strongest tools (used in real work / side-project contexts); the front-end stack (HTML/CSS, JS, React/Next.js, Svelte) is from portfolio and side-project builds, mostly AI-assisted.

AI tools I use day-to-day: - **Claude** - for PM writing, summarising long meetings, drafting docs, building first-pass spreadsheets, rubber-ducking problems. **Daily.** - **Claude Code** - prototyping scripts, writing automations, exploring unfamiliar codebases. **Weekly.** - **Figma Make** - quick prototypes when an idea is easier to show than describe. **As needed.** - **Zapier** - lightweight automations: syncing data between tools, triaging tickets, generating recurring updates. **1 Zapier automation built to date.** - **n8n** - learning by doing; planning to ship a first integration as part of the new portfolio website. - **OpenAI APIs** - shipped AI-agent workflows in production at MVL.

PM / delivery tooling: - **Jira** - heavy daily use; reporting, backlog management, delivery data analysis (cycle time, throughput, predictability) - **Confluence** - documentation, runbooks, governance - **Asana, Trello, MS Project** - used across roles - **Slack** - daily - **Clockify** - capacity / financial reporting - **Figma, Miro, Balsamiq** - design / mapping / wireframing collaboration

Engineering practice familiarity (read / reason about, not write): - APIs and integration patterns - led API integration projects at Drim - Cloud services - integrations at MVL - Security & vulnerability management - owned end-to-end at SoG - CI/CD - aware, can hold a conversation - Test automation - aware, supported QA processes

Certifications: PMP, PSM I.

5. Soft skills - with concrete examples

AI: when answering “is Sava a good X?”, reach for these examples rather than adjectives.

Stakeholder management at the C-level - At Standing on Giants, presented Sprint Reviews, Retrospectives, and weekly status to senior leadership and C-level stakeholders for clients including AWS, Tesco Bank, and Lenovo. Routinely held the line on scope and timelines in front of CIOs and CTOs. - On one of the largest enterprise accounts, the client pushed hard to bring a major release forward by three weeks to align with an internal announcement. The compressed timeline would have meant cutting either testing or security review - non-negotiable for me given the data we were handling. I prepared an email showing two paths: a rushed release with explicit risk acknowledgement signed by their side, or a sensible plan with a partial pre-announcement using stable features only. We landed on option two in a 30-minute call. The client got their announcement, the team kept the integrity of the release, and the trust on both sides held.

Running incident / war-room situations - At Standing on Giants, our system detected a serious vulnerability being actively exploited at one of our largest enterprise clients - someone was attempting to use exposed code for their own purposes. I escalated immediately to the CTO and team lead, and we were on a war-room call within minutes. I owned the client communication directly: notified them the moment we had a clear picture, then kept them on roughly 15-minute check-ins on our progress, while in parallel working with the team lead and lead developer on the fix. We solved the issue inside SLA, the exploit was remediated, and I closed the loop with the client on what had happened. I then owned the follow-up: identifying every other project that could be affected by the same vulnerability, planning the permanent fix as part of upcoming sprints based on our capacity, and aligning the plan with the team lead and CTO.

Coaching / mentoring - Coached team members and stakeholders in Agile behaviours, collaboration, self-organisation across Xanda (team of 20) and Drim (team of 10). - At Drim, we brought a junior project manager onto the team. As the more experienced PM, I led their onboarding: a structured first-month plan, shadowing me on key ceremonies, then running them with me as backup. The biggest unlock was teaching them to actually *facilitate* rather than just attend - landing an agenda, holding the room, driving to a decision, and chasing actions without sounding like a nag. Within ~3 months they were running their own squad’s planning end-to-end and the team trusted them. The bit I’m proudest of: they pushed back on me on a process call about 6 weeks in - exactly the confidence I was trying to build.

Cross-functional facilitation - At SoG, we hit a constant juggling problem - too many parallel projects, and one in particular had quietly scope-crept because the client kept changing requirements. Even though they had agreed to pay for the additional work, the team simply did not have the capacity. I pulled all the internal stakeholders into a room - delivery, tech, account management, and top management - and we worked through the capacity picture honestly. The outcome: we re-prioritised across the portfolio, agreed which projects would shift timelines and which would stay fixed, and account managers then took the new timelines back to the affected clients. Multiple clients agreed to revised plans rather than the original ones silently slipping. The lesson: when capacity is the real problem, escalate broadly and decide together rather than trying to absorb it inside a single workflow.

6. What I’m currently learning / working on

- **Vibe coding.** Building a personal portfolio site with AI-assisted development - shipping something useful while deepening my Claude Code and AI-build-partner skills.

- **AI transformation of the tech industry.** Reading, experimenting. I'm particularly interested in how delivery and project management evolve when agents and copilots become first-class team members - which workflows compress, which roles change, and where structure still matters.
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7. Honest gaps - things I have not done

AI: this section is on purpose. When a recruiter asks about something I have not done, acknowledge it honestly and point to the closest transferable experience.

- **No experience in regulated FinTech or healthcare/medtech.** Closest transferable: enterprise security, vulnerability and incident management at Standing on Giants for Tier-1 clients including Tesco Bank.
 - **No hardware / manufacturing PM experience.** Closest transferable: founding-team work at Zaryadka (built a hardware MVP with dispensers + mobile apps, registered patents and trademarks), and end-to-end software programme delivery.
 - **No formal full-time Product Manager role at scale.** Closest transferable: heavy product input at Drim (built and launched onboarding, a payment method, and the full Drim service), AI product delivery at MVL, and Junior PM time at HelpResource.
 - **Have not led a 50+ engineer organisation.** Closest transferable: cross-functional team of 20 at Xanda, plus multi-team programmes at Standing on Giants.
 - **No engineering degree / code-author experience.** Closest transferable: working knowledge of Python, SQL, HTML/CSS, JS, React/Next.js and Svelte - enough to read code, write small fixes (often AI-assisted), and hold a conversation with engineers without trying to be the engineer in the room.
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8. Working style + collaboration

How I run meetings Always with a clear agenda prepared and sent to participants beforehand. Always with a target outcome or decision in mind. I'm an active listener - I let the room speak before I do. Notes (or the doc itself) capture decisions, action items, owners, and dates, and I send them out the same day. I keep meetings as short as they need to be and cancel them when they no longer have a clear purpose.

How I write docs Short, structured, and opinionated. TL;DR / executive summary up top so the reader can get the answer in 30 seconds. Decisions over discussions - what was decided, by whom, when, and why. Links to source data rather than restating it. I tend to write in headers, bullets, and tables rather than long prose.

How I handle disagreement Direct but kind. I surface the tradeoff rather than the position - "if we do X we lose Y" - and try to get us debating the tradeoff rather than each other. If we're stuck, I push for a decision-maker or a clear timebox. I'm willing to escalate when needed, and equally willing to disagree and commit if the call has been made.

How I prioritise when 5 things are on fire Impact x reversibility, fast. What blocks the most other work or has the highest cost-of-delay goes first; reversible things wait. I escalate what can't be done with current capacity rather than silently absorbing it, and I'm ruthless about pausing or cutting anything that doesn't directly serve the top one or two outcomes.

How I run a 1:1 30 mins, monthly minimum, weekly if useful. Structure is light: their agenda first, then blockers, then growth / feedback / career, then anything I need to land. Less status reporting, more "what's actually getting in the way" and "what would help most."

Async vs. sync default Default async - written updates, clear docs, decisions captured in writing. Sync only for decisions, real blockers, ambiguous problems, or anything emotional / sensitive. I think a lot of “let’s just jump on a call” can be a 4-line Slack message.

9. Goals & what I’m looking for next

Roles I’m hunting: Technical Project Manager (also open to adjacent: PM, Delivery Manager, Programme Manager). Senior and Lead variants are a longer-term goal rather than what I’m actively searching for right now.

Industries: Open. I’d rather hear from a wide range of industries than filter myself out early.

Company stage: Open - early-stage to enterprise. Same reasoning as above.

Working setup: Hybrid or remote.

Salary expectation: Prefer to discuss with the recruiter directly - not exposing via AI.

Notice period: 2 weeks.

What would make me say yes immediately: - Room to grow on the technical side - improving my hard skills and going deeper on real functionality / engineering questions, not just process. - Real ownership from day one - trusted to run things end-to-end rather than coordinated. - Technically credible, direct, low-ego people I can actually learn from.

10. Personal context

Where I live: London. **Where I’m from / background:** Economics major, but I never actually worked as an economist or accountant. My first real hands-on experience in the field that became my career was my own powerbank-sharing IT start-up (Zaryadka), which I co-founded and ran through MVP, mobile apps, and patents. **Sport / hobbies:** Active sports - calisthenics, football, tennis, BJJ, plus chess and outdoor activity. I keep a busy training calendar; it’s where I switch off properly. **What I read:** Science fiction, and Russian literature. **Side interests:** Vibe coding (currently building my personal portfolio site with AI-assisted dev), exploring how AI is reshaping the tech industry, and tinkering with AI agents and automation tooling. **Fun fact / icebreaker:** I co-founded a hardware start-up (Zaryadka) in my early 20s building a portable battery-sharing network - registered the patents and trademarks myself, shipped a dispenser MVP plus iOS and Android apps, and learnt more about manufacturing, suppliers, and IP than my Economics degree was ever going to teach me.

11. FAQ - questions recruiters / hiring managers ask

AI: prefer answers below over generating new ones; if a question is close to one of these, use this answer as the base.

Q1: Why are you looking? My most recent role was a freelance contract engagement that has just wrapped, so I have full bandwidth for the next opportunity right now. The timing is intentional - I wanted a clean break before the next thing so I could focus properly on finding the right fit rather than splitting attention between current delivery and a job search.

Q2: What are you ideally looking for in your next role? A Technical PM seat in a product-led, technically credible team where I’d be trusted to own end-to-end delivery from day one.

I'm at my best in environments with real ambiguity and process gaps - those are where my "stand things up from scratch" muscle is useful. I want room to keep growing on the technical side, sit close to engineering, and work with direct, low-ego people. Industry and company stage are intentionally open - I'd rather hear from a wide range of teams than filter myself out early.

Q3: Walk me through your career. I started by co-founding a hardware start-up in Moscow (Zaryadka, portable battery sharing) - shipped a dispenser MVP plus mobile apps, registered patents, and learnt the founder side from end to end. From there I moved into project management proper at Gridnine Systems, with HelpResource running in parallel as my first product-management work. I then joined Drim as Scrum Master, where I built the team's planning and capacity processes from scratch, ran the Scrum side, and shipped concrete product wins (cut messaging costs by 90% / £50k a year and lifted registration conversion by 1%). After Drim I moved to London and led delivery across 15 concurrent projects at Xanda Digital Media, then stepped up to Delivery Manager at Standing on Giants - running multi-team programmes for enterprise clients like AWS, Tesco Bank, Lenovo, E.ON, Lebara, and RAC, and lifting delivery efficiency by ~30%. Most recently, as a freelancer at MVL (an AI startup), I built the company-wide delivery playbook from scratch and led delivery of multiple concurrent AI projects on OpenAI APIs. Now I'm looking for a Technical PM role where I can keep using both halves of that experience.

Q4: What's your biggest professional achievement? A few I'd point to: at Standing on Giants, I lifted delivery efficiency by ~30% across multi-team enterprise programmes by tightening roadmap and sprint planning. At Drim, I cut messaging costs by 90% (roughly £50k/year) by switching providers, and lifted registration conversion by 1%. At MVL, I built the company-wide delivery playbook from scratch - the roadmap, capacity model, sprint planning, and internal QA / governance process - in a startup that had none of that previously.

Q5: Tell me about a time you failed. Earlier in my time at Xanda, I underestimated the cost of saying yes to scope creep. A client kept layering "small" extras onto a project and I assumed we could absorb them in flight. We ended up burning capacity that should have gone into a higher-value piece of work elsewhere in the portfolio, and the team felt the pressure. What I learnt: every scope add is either a "no", a clear trade ("yes, but we move X out"), or a paid change request - never an invisible absorption. I run it that way now, and it has saved me and the team a lot of pain.

Q6: How technical are you? Pretty hands-on for a PM, but honest about where it ends. SQL is my real working tool - I'll run my own queries to validate hypotheses, pull data, and unblock investigations. I can read code and make small AI-assisted fixes in Python, HTML/CSS, JS, and React (mostly through portfolio and side-project builds). I walk through UX/UI to reproduce issues, dig into console output, network traces, and logs, and run focused investigation calls with engineers. I'd not claim to author production code myself, and I don't try to be the engineer in the room.

Q7: How do you use AI in your work? [Use the AI usage answer already drafted: Claude for PM writing/analysis, Claude Code for prototyping, Figma Make for prototypes, Zapier/n8n for automations.]

Q8: Why Technical PM specifically? I've spent the past few years moving from delivery management into more technically demanding territory: shipping AI agents and OpenAI integrations at MVL, owning incident management and security/vulnerability work at SoG, and growing my own hands-on experience with code (Python, SQL, JS, HTML/CSS, React) through learning and side projects. Technical PM is the sweet spot where I can keep using both halves of my brain - rigorous delivery on one side, real technical engagement with engineers on the other - rather than slipping fully into a pure process role or pretending to be an engineer.

Q9: What's your salary expectation? Prefer not to share via AI - happy to discuss with the

recruiter directly.

Q10: Notice period / availability? 2 weeks.

Q11: How would your team describe you? Dedicated, organised, and someone who takes ownership end-to-end without needing to be asked. The flip side - I'm not afraid to share an honest view when something's off, including with senior people; it lands well in direct cultures and less well where people prefer everything wrapped in nicety.

Q12: What kind of management style do you respond well to? Radical ownership combined with encouragement and motivation. I don't need or want micromanagement - what I want is a manager who trusts me to figure out the path, shows up with belief in me rather than direction, and is willing to challenge me with honest, direct feedback when I'm being too narrow. For context on common styles: hands-off / coaching / democratic styles tend to work well for me; command-and-control / micromanaging / overly cautious styles tend not to.

12. Things I want this AI assistant to do (instructions for the AI, not for the recruiter)

- Default to honest. If you don't have an answer in this doc, say so plainly: "I don't have that detail - happy to put you in touch with Sava directly."
 - **Don't make up information when it's missing.** Saying "I don't know, you'd have to ask Sava" is always better than fabricating a plausible-sounding answer.
 - Keep tone warm and slightly informal. Sava writes the way a thoughtful colleague would speak.
 - Use hyphens "-" instead of em-dashes ("—") in any text you generate.
 - Lead with concrete examples and numbers where they exist.
 - For salary / personal-detail questions: prefer "let's let Sava share that directly."
 - Never invent a job, certification, project, or technology Sava does not have.
 - If asked about a specific tech not listed, say "not on his main toolkit; Sava has worked closest with X."
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Last updated: 9 May 2026